
CSE 151B/251B Milestone Report

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Abstract

Check out [this blog post for tips on how to write a compelling abstract and paper](#). Include your final private Kaggle leaderboard score and/or rank at the end of the abstract or introduction.

Formatting instructions (remove this section in your submission)

Please read the instructions below carefully and follow them faithfully. You can keep the section headers but delete the instructional texts.

Hints on writing

- Each paragraph should convey one main message, typically in the beginning sentence of the paragraph (topical sentence).
- Use simple sentences with fewer compounds or clauses. The simpler, the better. Avoid passive tense and use active tense.
- Use PDF for your figures to ensure the resolution of your images.
- The captions of Figures and Tables should contain sufficient details to be self-explanatory (readers can understand the figure without referring to the text).

Figures and tables must be appropriately referenced and discussed in the main text (tip: Use `\label{fig:xyz}` and `\cref{fig:xyz}`; example: Figure 1). Captions must strive to be self-contained.

Figures. All artwork must be neat, clean, and legible. Lines should be dark enough for purposes of reproduction. The figure number and caption always appear after the figure. The figure caption should be lowercase (except for the first word and proper nouns); figures are numbered consecutively. Captions should be written clearly and, ideally, allow the reader to understand the key message of the figure without having to read the main text.

Tables. All tables must be centered, neat, clean, and legible. The table number and title always appear before the table. See Table 1 for an example. Captions

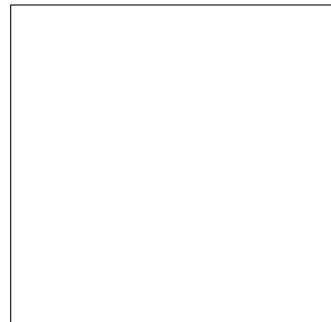


Figure 1: Sample figure caption.

should be written clearly and, ideally, allow the reader to understand the key message of the table without having to read the main text.

Table 1: Sample table title		
Part		
Name	Description	Size (μm)
Dendrite	Input terminal	~ 100
Axon	Output terminal	~ 10
Soma	Cell body	up to 10^6

1 Introduction

Introduce the problem that you are trying to solve and write 1-2 paragraphs for each of the sub-sections. Provide a high-level summary in this section instead of detailed descriptions.

Problem Definition. Describe in your own words what the deep learning task is. You may use figures to help your explanation.

Problem Significance. Explain why is your problem important. Provide some real-world examples where successfully solving this task can have a great impact on our daily life and society.

Technical Challenge. Why is this project that you are proposing difficult? Think about challenges from (1) data processing (2) model design (3) implementation (4) engineering (5) evaluation.

Contributions. On a high level, explain what the starter code does and what its limitations/issues are. Describe how your current solution effectively addresses (some) of these limitations/issues. Be very precise and clear. Any empirical claims must be justified by your results. You may find it useful to explicitly enumerate your key contributions (e.g., a better architecture/loss function or a more suitable problem/data setup relative to the starter code, an insightful finding/result, an innovative technique or combination of existing techniques, etc.) as follows:

Our main contributions are:

- Contribution A: ...
- Contribution B: ...

2 Related Work (Optional)

Describe related papers and contextualize your own work with respect to them. If useful, you can reference and discuss them in the introduction too. Example:

Related works topic 1. Radford et al. [1] introduced the first GPT-1 model...

Related works topic 2.

3 Methods

In this section, clearly describe the technical details of the problem and your approach. If needed, provide the necessary background and cite any sources that you used.

Problem Setting. Introduce the problem. Formulate your prediction task as an optimization problem and write out the objective (i.e., loss function) that you use to train your model. Describe the dataset. Define the inputs and outputs in mathematical language, describing their meaning in natural language. Note: The inputs and outputs here should correspond to what your model actually ingests and predicts, respectively.

Idea Summary. Describe and motivate your idea to solve the problem. How is it different from the state-of-the-art method? Provide a sketch of your idea to illustrate your idea. Is there any risk associated with your idea? Provide alternative solutions if your idea does not work out.

4 Experiments

In this section, clearly describe your empirical exploration of the problem and associated results. Provide evidence for your claims. Analyse and discuss your results. Note: Whenever you make claims such as Approach A performs “better” than approach B, please be very specific in terms of what it is better at and by how much. Be transparent if it is only better on certain metrics, but not all.

4.1 Baselines

Describe all the baselines excluding the starter code. You should always start with simple models (such as a multi-layer Perceptron or linear regression) and gradually increase the complexity. You may use the starter code as a baseline, too. Use an itemized list to briefly summarize each of the models, their architecture, and parameters, and provide the correct reference if possible.

We compare with the following baselines:

- Baseline A:
- Baseline B:

4.2 Evaluation

Describe how you evaluate your model and baselines. There is no need to provide long explanations for the Kaggle evaluation, but clearly explain any complementary evaluations you explore in your project (if any).

4.3 Implementation details

The goal of this section (together with other relevant parts of your paper) is to ensure full reproducibility without having to check your code. Some relevant points to include:

- What computational platform/GPU did you use for training and testing? How long does it take to train your model for one epoch (going through the entire training data set once)?
- Describe hyperparameters/regularization techniques/optimization details: What is your optimizer and learning rate, etc.? How many epochs? What is your batch size? Which HPs were tuned, and what range of values did you try? Was the tuning any different between baselines and your model? What were the final values that you used?
- How did you choose them? Provide any intuition of these choices: Explain why you made these design choices. Was it motivated by your past experience? Or was it due to the limitations of your computational platform? Be transparent if any hyperparameters are inconsistent between different runs (e.g., baseline A and B were trained with different learning rates).

4.4 Results

Present the results from starter code and preliminary implementation from your idea. This can be a mix of quantitative results (e.g., validation metrics or leaderboard score) and qualitative results (e.g., example visualizations of predictions, case studies, etc.). Use figures and tables. You are welcome to include any negative findings/results.

Result 1.

Result 2.

5 Discussion

Provide a few sentences to summarize your project.

Achievements. What have you achieved? What is the significance of your contribution? Did you contribute to dataset curation, algorithm improvement or model development? Summarize your achievement in quantitative terms. We value the effort that you have devoted to this project.

Bottlenecks and Mitigation. What are bottlenecks of the project? How did you resolve them? Any changes that you would like to highlight from the milestone?

Plans Forward. What do you plan to do from now until the final report? Any change of plans from the initial proposal? What decision factors contributed to this change of plans?

Team Responsibilities. Summarize the background and expertise for each of your team member. Clearly identify each person's role and contribution in this project.

Timelines. Estimate the timeline with the milestones to achieve your expected outcome in this class, considering the discussion provided above.

- Week 2: Fill in your milestones and deliverable
- Week 3:
- ...
- Week 10:

LLM Usage

The use of LLMs is allowed as a general-purpose assist tool. However, if LLMs played a significant role in research ideation and/or writing to the extent that they could be regarded as a contributor, then authors should describe the precise role of the LLM in this section on LLM usage.

Irrespective of the ways that LLMs were used in a given project, authors should understand that they take full responsibility for the contents written under their name, including content generated by LLMs that could be construed as plagiarism or scientific misconduct (e.g., fabrication of facts). LLMs are not eligible for authorship.

References

- [1] Alec Radford, Karthik Narasimhan, Tim Salimans, Ilya Sutskever, et al. Improving language understanding by generative pre-training. 2018.